proceedings of the Council of State in order to remain an obedient and faithful son, could he prove to be a more malleable domino?

In the end, the British cast their lot with Hari Singh but only after the Resident, Sir John Wood, privately read[12] out the riot act to Hari Singh and secured his consent to the long-established practice of non-interference in the frontier areas by state officials, and he also agreed that state officials would take no action in Ladakh without consulting the British Joint Commission.[13] But, this episode ended the untrammelled hegemony of the British in the state as Hari Singh kept standing up against the British on several issues, gradually culminating into the events of August 1947 when he thwarted British designs and took decisions that ultimately led to the state being divided between India and Pakistan, along military lines. His actions also resulted in the Congress-led Indian Government deposing him as the ruler of the state, just as the British had done with his predecessor, Maharaja Pratap Singh.

Maharaja Hari Singh inherited a state which had an overwhelmingly large Muslim population; this was a unique political situation where a Hindu ruler was ruling over a Muslim majority. The situation in the rest of India, till the advent of British rule in 1757, had been the very opposite.